

EMPLOYEE ATTRITION: Findings and Recommendations

Prepared for: HR Director | Subject: Why employees are leaving, and what we can do about it

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We looked closely at our employee data to understand why people leave the company. The goal was simple: find out which factors matter most, so HR can focus its time and budget where it will have the biggest impact. The short answer is that turnover is not caused by one single issue — it is a mix of pay, workload, job role, and how new the employee is to the company.

What We Found

- **Department matters:** Employees in Sales and Human Resources leave at a noticeably higher rate than other teams. Research & Development has the strongest retention of any department.
- **One role stands out:** Sales Representatives have the highest turnover of any job in the company, making this the single most at-risk role.
- **Pay plays a real role:** Employees with lower monthly income are more likely to leave than higher-paid peers, though pay is only part of the story (see below).
- **Overtime is a warning sign:** Employees who frequently work overtime are more likely to quit, suggesting workload and burnout are driving some departures.
- **Most exits happen early:** The majority of employees who leave do so within their first one to two years, pointing to a new-hire retention and onboarding problem rather than a long-term loyalty problem.

Does Salary Explain Everything?

No. Salary is a meaningful factor, but it works together with workload (overtime) and job role. Two employees earning the same salary can have very different odds of leaving depending on their role and how much overtime they put in. This means raising pay alone will not solve the problem — workload and role-specific support need attention too.

Recommendations

- **Prioritize Sales for retention efforts:** Build a targeted retention program for Sales (especially Sales Representatives) and for employees in their first two years. This could include closer manager check-ins, clearer career paths, and early mentorship.
- **Address overtime and workload:** Reduce excessive overtime where possible, or pair it with better compensation and work-life balance options, particularly in the roles most affected.

A Word of Caution

This analysis is based on past patterns in our employee data, not a guarantee of future behavior. It should be used as a guide to focus attention and conversations — not as the sole basis for decisions about any individual employee. It works best alongside manager judgment and direct conversations with staff.